

Zomato: making the order feel as good as the food

Analysis of the user journey, strengths and weaknesses of the Zomato food delivery app, with three proposed improvements and sample mockups.

1. Overview

Zomato is one of India's most used food delivery apps and part of Eternal Ltd, which also owns Blinkit, District and Hyperpure. The consumer app keeps the Zomato name. It combines restaurant discovery, delivery, dining out and the Gold membership, and has recently added features such as Healthy Mode dish scoring. Because so much is packed into one product, it is a good case for studying how a busy interface affects a simple goal: getting dinner ordered quickly and confidently.

Scope and method

This is an expert heuristic evaluation, not primary research. I walked through the ordering flow as a first-time-in-a-while user, scored each stage against Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics, and compared what I saw with public information about the product. Findings are hypotheses to validate with usability tests and analytics before build.

Persona used for the walkthrough (assumed)

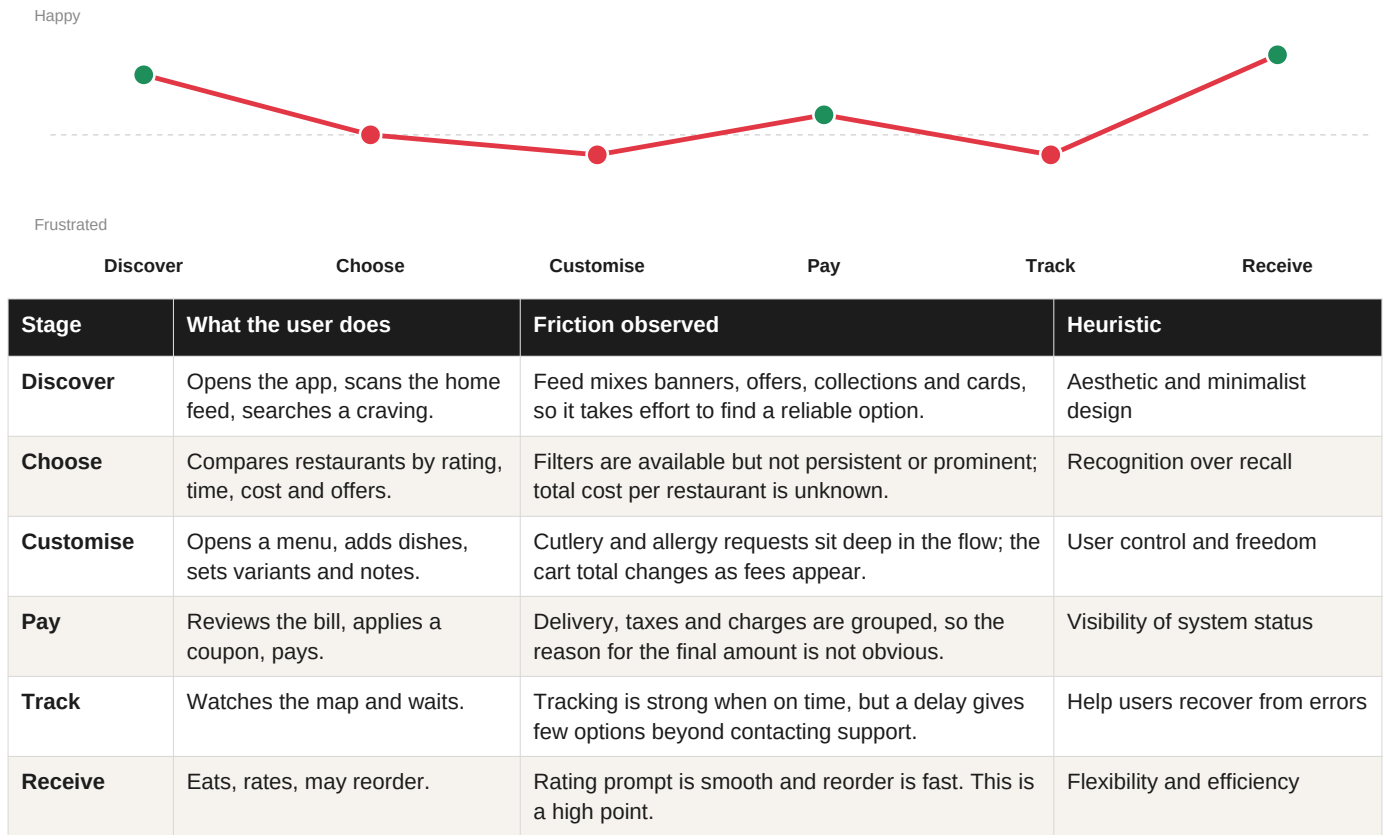
Ayesha, 26 Product analyst, orders dinner 3 to 4 times a week after work.	Goal Find something good, know the exact price and get it warm without chasing status.	Frustrations Too many offers to scan, surprise fees at checkout, unclear delays.
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Key findings at a glance

Strengths	Weaknesses	Improvements proposed
Fast reordering and saved addresses Rich photos, ratings and filters Live tracking with rider contact Clear, recognisable brand	Crowded home screen Fees only obvious at the last step Vague help when an order runs late Special requests hard to find	1. Quick filters plus Order again 2. Transparent bill and instructions 3. Proactive delay recovery

2. User journey analysis

The journey below follows Ayesha from opening the app to finishing her meal. Red dots mark stages where friction is highest in my evaluation.



3. Strengths and weaknesses

Strengths

- **Efficient repeat use.** Saved addresses, payment methods and past orders make the second order much faster than the first, which supports habit formation.
- **Trustworthy content.** Dish photos, ratings, delivery time and cost-for-two give users enough signals to judge a restaurant at a glance.
- **Excellent live tracking.** The map, status steps and rider contact reduce anxiety while the user waits.
- **Growing personalisation.** Features like Healthy Mode dish scoring and the Gold membership show a move toward tailoring the experience to needs, not just menus.
- **Consistent brand.** The red identity, tone of voice and card patterns are recognisable across screens.

Weaknesses

- **Information overload on the home screen.** Promotions and content compete with the core task of finding food, which raises decision fatigue.
- **Late price clarity.** Users see item prices early but the full amount only at checkout, which can feel like a surprise even when the fees are legitimate.
- **Weak recovery when things go wrong.** A late order leaves the user waiting or contacting support instead of being offered choices.
- **Hidden special requests.** Cutlery, allergy or cooking notes are easy to miss, and users cannot tell if the restaurant acknowledged them.
- **Feature crowding.** Delivery, dining, membership and health features share one surface, so navigation labels carry more weight than they should.

Heuristic scorecard (1 = poor, 5 = excellent)

Heuristic	Score	Note
Visibility of system status	4	Tracking is clear; delays and fees are less so.
Match with the real world	4	Familiar food language and cues.
User control and freedom	3	Easy to edit the cart; requests are hard to reach.
Consistency and standards	4	Patterns are stable across flows.
Error prevention and recovery	2.5	Few recovery paths for late or wrong orders.
Recognition rather than recall	3	Filters and history could be more visible.
Aesthetic and minimalist design	2.5	Home feed is busy.

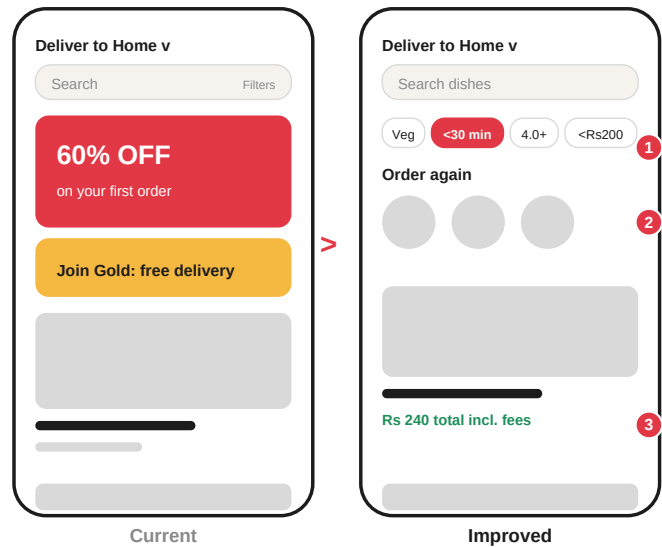
4. Three improvements with sample mockups

Mockups are simplified sketches. Numbers on the improved screens match the numbered points in each list.

Improvement 1: Faster decisions on Home

Problem. The home feed asks users to scan many banners before they reach restaurants, and filters are easy to miss.

- 1. Add a persistent chip row for the most-used filters (Veg, under 30 min, 4.0+, budget).
 - 2. Put an Order again row first for returning users so the fastest path is one tap.
 - 3. Show an estimated total including fees on each restaurant card.
- Move promotions into a single slim strip below the results header.

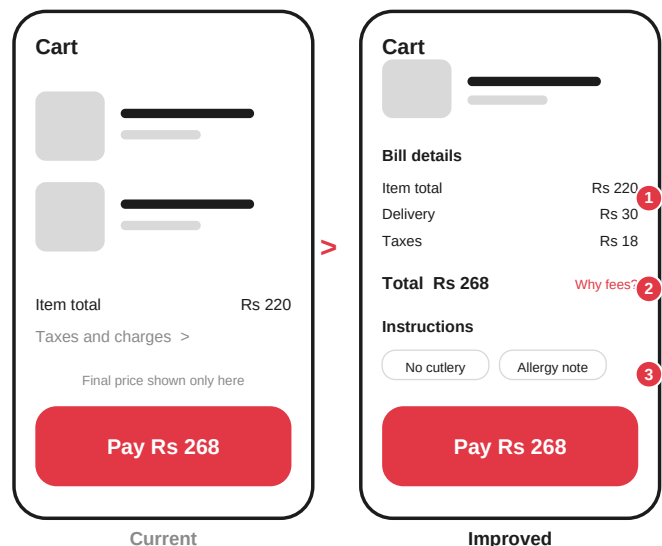


Expected impact. Fewer scrolls and taps before the first add-to-cart. Track time to first add, filter usage and reorder share in an A/B test.

Improvement 2: A transparent bill and visible requests

Problem. Users learn the full price late, and special requests such as cutlery or allergies are hard to find and never confirmed.

- 1. Itemise the bill: item total, delivery, taxes, each on its own line.
 - 2. Add a Why these fees? link that explains charges in one plain sentence.
 - 3. Bring instruction chips (No cutlery, Allergy note) into the cart and show when the restaurant confirms them.
- Keep the pay button amount identical to the bill total.

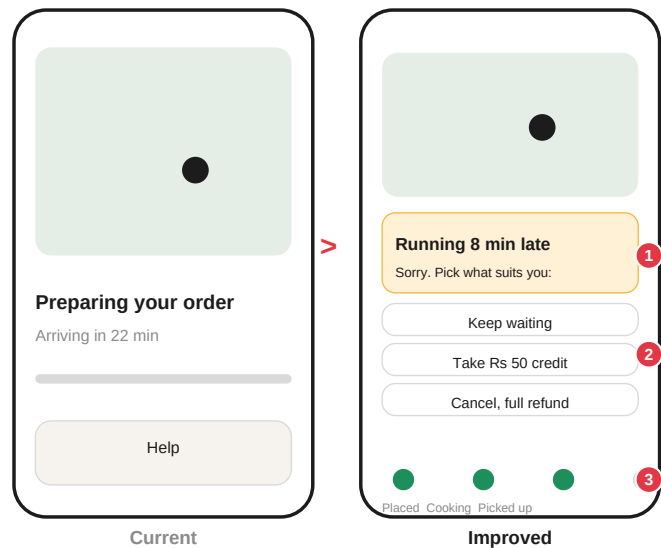


Expected impact. Higher trust at payment and fewer cart abandonments. Track checkout completion, support tickets about fees and request-related complaints.

Improvement 3: Proactive recovery when an order runs late

Problem. When delivery slips, the user mostly waits or contacts support. Fixing the problem takes effort at the worst moment.

- 1. Show a clear late banner as soon as the estimate slips, with the new time.
- 2. Offer choices in one tap: keep waiting, take credit, or cancel with a refund when eligible.
- 3. Keep a simple timeline (Placed, Cooking, Picked up, Delivered) so progress stays visible.
- Send one calm notification instead of repeated alerts.



Expected impact. Lower support contacts and better repeat ordering after a late delivery. Track late-order support rate, credit uptake and next-30-day reorder rate.

5. Prioritisation and measurement

Improvement	User value	Effort	Primary metric	Priority
1. Quick filters and Order again	High	Low	Time to first add-to-cart	Do first
2. Transparent bill and requests	High	Medium	Checkout completion	Do next
3. Late-order recovery	Medium to high	High	Late-order support rate	Plan

6. Conclusion

Zomato already does the hard parts well: it has a large, trusted catalogue and tracking that reassures users. The opportunity is in reducing effort at the two moments that matter most, choosing and paying, and in handling delays with empathy. The three changes above are small in interface terms but target the biggest friction in the journey. Next steps would be a five-person usability test on the current flow, then A/B tests of the improved home and cart screens.

Limitations: this study is based on heuristic review and public sources, not on Zomato's analytics or interviews. Mockups are conceptual and are not official Zomato designs.